



MONTHLY UPDATE

Strategies, plans and policies: monthly update, July 2026

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40 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Benin

The Cotonou cyber-hub programme now carries four parts: hosting the continental cyber forum, [a cybersecurity-only incubator at Abomey-Calavi](#), a statewide risk-management framework with a crisis exercise for state information-security officers, and [300 police unit heads trained during 2026](#).

Two instruments moved in opposite directions on the same problem. A [joint circular of 24 July requires every state structure to move archive and procedure management onto digital tools](#), with the returns stated as fiscal and environmental rather than as service improvement, and with no implementation deadline, budget line, scope definition or compliance mechanism; the circular's own text is not published. Against that, a [national digital public infrastructure roadmap is in draft on a once-only principle](#) — the state ceasing to ask citizens for documents it issued itself — with the agency framing the hard part as governance and coherence across infrastructure already built rather than as further building.

Botswana

On 13 July the regulator and the environment department [launched a national e-waste management strategy and signed an inter-agency memorandum](#). No targets, budget, collection volumes or implementation dates were published, and the strategy document itself is not on file.

Cameroon

An account of 27 July set out where the satellite licence stands: a [draft concession convention and specification finalised by the regulator, the file at the ministry undecided for more than two years, and the 2024 seizure circular still operative](#). The objections on record are lawful interception, armed-group use, and the incumbent's commercial position.

Cape Verde

A [strategic consultation on the national digital transformation agenda](#) was convened in Praia on 6 August, seating public administration, private sector, academia and named specialists, whose contributions are to feed a national diagnosis and the agenda's priorities. Its stated scope runs from interoperability of the public administration to digital inclusion, data protection and cybersecurity. No draft, title, adoption date or budget is held, and nothing connects it to the governance framework whose terms of reference the finance ministry issued in 2025.

Central African Republic

The World Bank published a public finance review of the Central African Republic on 2 July 2026, and it puts digitisation at the centre of what it proposes. Against domestic revenue of about [FCFA 187bn, or 10.1% of GDP, in a 2025 budget of about FCFA 385bn](#), it argues for a rise to 12% in the short and medium term and 15% in the long term, and estimates that [digitising the tax administration alone could raise up to two points of GDP in the short term](#). Electronic public procurement and a digital cadastre are named among its longer-term recommendations, against [63% of public contracts let by direct award in 2023 and 11% of domestically financed investment executed that year](#).

It is the first independent assessment the base holds of the ground the government's own public-finances digitalisation plan 2025-2027 covers. That plan's costed operational annex, due in April 2025, is still unpublished.

Comoros

ANADEN, the digital development agency, [held the first meeting of its board of directors on 27 July 2026 at the Hôtel Retaj in Moroni](#), members having been named by decree n°26-075/PR of 11 June 2026. The board adopted its rules of procedure and elected Nourdine Mohamed of the Commissariat général au Plan as chair, Najwa Aichem Hissami Eddine of the Presidency of the Union as vice-chair and El Amine Souef of the ICT ministry as rapporteur. It then examined ANADEN's 2026 action plan, presented by director-general Said Mouinou Ahamada, who [framed the session as the institutional footing for delivery of the Stratégie Comores Numérique 2028](#) and called for tighter coordination between the state bodies represented on the board. The agency had operated without constituted governance organs since the decree naming the board was signed seven weeks earlier.

Congo

A [public-finance digital transformation steering committee met for the first time on 15 July](#), chaired by the minister and seating the directors-general of the revenue authorities, on improving revenue collection, securing public funds and raising the quality of public spending. And the [ministry's roadmap places delivery in an interministerial task force under the Prime Minister rather than the ministry acting alone](#); a separate nine-point ministerial list of 10 July is not reconciled with it.

Cote d'Ivoire

The draft cyber-security strategy for 2026 to 2030 was [put to stakeholder review on 23 July](#) and awaits the Council of Ministers; the 2021 to 2025 text remains the instrument formally in force. The draft extends scope to artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and cloud.

The universal-service agency published its own five-year plan on 11 August. It rests on four pillars — universal connectivity, digital services and financial inclusion, digital usage and literacy, and operational excellence — across ten projects, four of them funded at FCFA 60.144bn through the national development plan and six from the agency's own funds. The stated targets are 300 newly connected localities, smartphone penetration of 80% by 2028 against 40% now, and more than 15,000 km of new fibre by 2028, against a starting point at which 70% of rural households have no internet access. No adoption instrument is published; the plan is the agency's own.

Djibouti

At WSIS 2026 in Geneva on 9 July the communications minister restated Vision Djibouti 2035 as the frame for a regional technology hub and sought ITU and Smart Africa support for public-service digitalisation and AI capacity. No instrument resulted.

DR Congo

Experts validated the sectoral digital economy policy 2026-2030 on 21 and 22 July, subject to completing the costing, indicators and institutional responsibilities. A restitution workshop on 29 and 30 July presented a ten-dimension maturity diagnostic and named the instruments to be articulated: the digital and data strategies, the AI strategy, the identity platform, the sovereign cloud, a certification authority and a cybersecurity agency, plus a rule barring AI platform deployment without data quality, auditability and human supervision.

The connectivity side of that framework acquired numbers in August. The universal service fund published a National Connectivity Strategy 2026-2035 built on a shared-infrastructure model led by a tower company, and signed subsidy agreements with the four mobile operators to extend service to 40 underserved localities covering about 258,000 people, against a target of 3,000 localities and 16 million people by 2030. The strategy text is not held, and neither the subsidy amounts, the tower company nor the selection rule for the first 40 localities is stated.

Egypt

The month's largest single transaction was spectrum: 410 MHz awarded across 1.8, 2.6 and 3.5 GHz for US\$3.5bn, doubling operator holdings at once, which the minister said matches all spectrum allocated in Egypt over the previous thirty years. The strategy behind it is not held; Egypt reformed 2.6 GHz for 5G rather than licensing dedicated mid-band, and set no coverage or speed obligations. Service coverage stands at 242 services, over 270 targeted by end-2026, and a national data-centre strategy is under preparation around data localisation, with no publication date or draft text held.

Equatorial Guinea

The ministry's second extraordinary directive council adopted a consolidated July–December 2026 action plan of 35 strategic objectives under three national priorities, one of them restoring sovereignty over the national digital space including the .GQ domain. Named measures include a Comisión Nacional de Negociación to recover the domain and a requirement that frequency licence fees and registration charges be paid in full into the Public Treasury. The plan goes to the interministerial council and then to the Council of Ministers, which decides which measures are recorded and funded.

The commission on state-participation companies [heard candidates on 29 July](#) for director-general and deputy posts at GITGE, ANDEGE, INSESO and Gepetrol Servicios against stated criteria, with appointments provisional for six months.

Eswatini

The National Data Governance Policy [was validated on 27 July 2026](#) by stakeholders from government, business, civil society, academia and development partners, with a stated cycle of 2027 to 2031 — a policy dated to begin the year after it was drafted. Support runs through the Team Europe Data Governance in Africa initiative, the same channel behind the April 2026 workshop. The text is not published and no adoption date is given.

Ethiopia

A National Digital Transformation Council meeting on 30 July restated that the programme is to be judged on lives changed rather than systems deployed — a measurement claim with no published measure behind it.

Gabon

The same 27 July Libreville seminar on space communications called for an autonomous national satellite system and sub-regional agreement for it to operate ([close of the seminar](#)).

Ghana

The government [announced a ten-year artificial-intelligence implementation plan on 29 July](#) with measurable annual milestones, built with United Nations partners.

Guinea

A [presidential decree of 27 July 2026 reshuffled the transition government](#), keeping Mourana Soumah at the Ministère de la Communication, de l'Économie numérique et de l'Innovation, which he has held since the February 2026 merger. Djenabou Touré takes Administration du Territoire et de la Décentralisation, the ministry supervising ONECI and the biometric civil-registration programme; a Djenabou Touré was director-general of elections and attended the ONECI signing three days earlier, and the source does not confirm they are the same person. A World Bank tender published the same week still names the predecessor department, MPTEN, as supervising WARDIP.

Kenya

A revised Hustler Fund merchant tariff schedule takes effect on 7 August, delivered as voluntary alignment with central bank pricing principles rather than a gazetted rule.

Lesotho

The month's policy work is a strategy being drafted rather than one adopted. A [National AI Strategy is being written at the same five-day Maseru workshop as the data-centre blueprint, opened on 17 August by the communications ministry with the United Nations in Lesotho](#), and is distinct from the National AI Policy signed in June. The deputy

prime minister's keynote asked for Lesotho's existing capabilities, safeguards, infrastructure, policy and human capacity to be settled before AI investment is scaled. No publication date, custodian, scope or cost is stated, and nothing beyond the workshop is on the record.

Liberia

The African Development Bank launched its [country strategy for 2026-2031 in Monrovia](#) on 30 July, cutting its sectors from four to three and funding an indicative 2026-2028 programme of UA 129m – US\$172.86m at the [February 2026 conversion](#) – of which 36.3% is unfunded. The only digital line in the indicative programme is a non-lending study on digital solutions for Monrovia traffic congestion, and the strategy's own ICT assessment cites a policy that expired in 2024.

Libya

On 26 July the Ministry of Civil Service [discussed implementation of its digital transformation plan with Huawei Libya](#), covering the ministry's systems and electronic services. No agreement, scope or value was announced.

On 4 August the same ministry [convened the General Information Authority, the Libyan Digital Company and its own IT office to prepare a national digital transformation plan](#) covering digitised administrative procedures, unified databases and integration between state institutions. No timetable, budget, lead agency or published document was stated, and the announcement was made on the ministry's Facebook page.

Madagascar

On 20 July the [Technical Assistance Facility for the Refondation](#) was launched at the Palais d'État d'Iavoloha, requested by the presidency and supported by UNDP, running 2026 to 2030, explicitly including the use of digital tools. Administrations had until end-July to submit proposals [through a dedicated digital platform](#); a steering committee screens them and selected interventions run three to nine months. 170 focal points were certified in advance.

Malawi

The draft national artificial intelligence strategy the UNESCO readiness assessment is intended to guide remains pre-adoption.

Mali

On 15 July, at the UEMOA digital economy salon in Ouagadougou, Mali [spoke for the three AES states and the salon adopted a Declaration de Ouagadougou](#) recommending that member governments place digital at the centre of national strategies, and identifying financing opportunities under the union's ICT fund. The [same communique records the minister at the Global Dialogue on AI Governance and the World Summit on the Information Society in Geneva from 6 to 10 July](#), arguing for Global South data rights, fairer sharing of the benefits of artificial intelligence, a capacity-building fund for least-developed countries, and the integration of African languages into AI models. Positions stated, with no instrument or commitment attached to any of them.

The same 1 August recommendations also included establishing a [Conseil national du Numerique](#).

Mauritius

At the summit on [16 July](#) the ICT minister committed the government to a National Data Governance Strategy covering cybersecurity, privacy and children's online safety, with no text or date stated.

Morocco

Digital Morocco 2030 is in force with a [US\\$250m acceleration programme attached in June](#), against a [technology sector at 6.8% of gross domestic product on a 2025 figure](#). Two held sources give its 2030 jobs target as 150,000 and as 240,000, and neither reconciles with the other.

Mozambique

The National Cyber Security Strategy 2026-2030 is under revision, succeeding a policy whose own period ended in 2025 ([institute account](#)).

On 22 July the communications minister told a banking and finance conference that the country is consolidating its legal and institutional framework, naming a national data governance policy among the instruments in preparation, and warned that once approved it will place obligations on companies and not only on the state ([ministerial account](#)).

Namibia

The ICT minister met a consultancy delegation in Windhoek on 3 August on trustworthy artificial intelligence, broadband access, cybersecurity, data centres, clean energy and women in technology, and stated that consultations on the strategy framework had already begun under the research council and that government has prioritised a strategy before introducing legislation ([ministerial account](#)). No contract, terms of reference or procurement route involving the consultancy is established ([second account](#)).

Nigeria

The central bank published [Payments System Vision 2028](#) on 17 June, a three-year horizon replacing a five-year one, from 2025 baselines of ₦1.2 quadrillion in electronic transactions and 69.5 million unique bank verification numbers. [Its 2028 targets are 95% financial inclusion, five million QR merchant outlets and a 70% reduction in fraud losses](#), and the 132-page text carries a stablecoin issuer-licensing regime no secondary account reported.

An [Artificial Intelligence and Cyber Diplomacy Unit](#) sits inside the foreign ministry, coordinating engagement on emerging technologies, established after the 2025 inaugural seminar.

Two coordination bodies were constituted in August, one with a deadline that tells you what it is. The Head of Service [inaugurated an eleven-member technical working committee to coordinate the federal civil service's cabinet-approved digital transformation agenda](#), tasked with [drafting the architecture, roadmap and governance mechanisms within one week](#) ahead of a steering committee; no terms of reference, budget or publication commitment is stated. And a national strategy for the digital transformation of technical and vocational education

was [validated at an Abuja workshop by UNESCO, the education ministry and the technical education board](#), which named connectivity, teacher digital competency, financing and coordination as the gaps to close before implementation. Validated is not adopted, and neither text is held.

The month's substantive instrument is the cloud policy. On 17 August the communications ministry [issued a National Digital Cloud Policy](#) superseding the 2019 cloud policy, in force on publication apart from its sovereignty provisions, which await presidential approval. It makes cloud the default for new federal systems, with [time-bound exemptions assessed by the IT development agency against published criteria and held in a register](#); pools ministry demand through the government infrastructure company into framework agreements bought on a National Digital Marketplace, with the procurement bureau overseeing compliance; and [sorts government and regulated data into four levels — national-security data hosted only in Nigeria, financial, health, biometric and identity data stored at rest in Nigeria, internal operational records hybrid by prior authorisation, and public data unrestricted](#). Commercial data carries no general localisation duty, and a regulator has to apply for a category to be designated sovereign. The [ministry states the 2019 Cloud First principle was applied unevenly for want of a coordinating framework](#), which is what the aggregation, marketplace, provider registration and compliance machinery is for. The policy text carries no published canonical link, and its relationship to the draft National Policy on Data and Cloud — five years in draft — is not stated.

Rwanda

The ministry's legacy-network retirement plan, announced on 28 July, extends beyond the switch-off dates themselves: extensions to the working timetable are temporary and regulator-approved only, and a government-commissioned study found more than two million people could still be on the older network in 2030 without a planned transition — the study is unpublished, so its method and definitions are unestablished. The ministry also published capability check codes and an institutional audit checklist covering messaging services, payment terminals, utility meters and vehicle trackers.

A development agency published on 6 July, from engagements run to March 2026, that Rwandan participants reported [no dedicated national organisation conducts artificial-intelligence risk assessments, evaluations or active monitoring of errors and harms](#) — while the technology is embedded in payments, judiciary filing, identity verification and service delivery — and that resolving an authentication error can take days or weeks. The report is qualitative and claims no representativeness.

The agency meant to hold that ground acquired its first stated function since cabinet approved it in June. Answering early-stage artificial-intelligence firms pressing publicly for infrastructure and funding, the ICT ministry [said on 17 August that the National AI Agency would coordinate shared compute and data-centre capacity for start-ups and researchers](#). No establishing law, compute capacity, access rule or budget is attached to it, and the base still records no sovereign compute of any kind.

Sao Tome and Principe

[A Data Governance Capacity Building Workshop ran 9–10 July 2026](#), led by the D4D Hub with GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD and KICTANET, on national adoption of the AU Data Policy Framework; translation into policy or institutional reform remains the stated goal, not yet delivered. [AUDA-NEPAD launched its Programme for African Developing Island](#)

[Economies at the AU's STC Ministerial Segment in Abidjan on 24 July](#), adopting a ministerial communiqué covering STP among seven island states on a 2026–2031 roadmap naming digital transformation, AI and automation, and the knowledge economy among its accelerators, with partners including Korea, the AfDB, the regional economic communities and the Indian Ocean Commission.

Senegal

The same account is the first to record a [national data strategy as adopted](#); its text is not on file and its adoption date is not established.

Two further AI instruments entered the record. A readiness assessment of 26 July records an [AI strategy adopted in 2023 on six orientations](#), correcting the base's earlier reading that no published strategy existed; the council of ministers communiqué of [29 July records an instruction to deploy a national AI development plan](#). Whether the plan supersedes or replaces the 2023 strategy is unestablished. A [blueprint for value creation through data](#) reached working-group stage on 1 and 2 July.

The telecommunications ministry [put a national online child-protection action plan in place on nine axes](#); an automated fetch on 31 July found no document on the ministry's own site.

Seychelles

Cabinet approved measures to operationalise the Multidimensional Vulnerability Index on 22 July 2026, naming "enhanced data and institutional capacity" and alignment of planning and budgeting frameworks as the instruments, with no implementation detail yet given. [President Herminie restated a "fully digitalised e-government by 2030" target on 4 August](#), while receiving Malta's first High Commissioner's credentials and naming bilateral technical cooperation as the route under discussion. On 10 August the institution meant to carry that work was described as back in place: [the National Institute for Science, Technology and Innovation has been reinstated, its Secretariat sitting under the Office of the Vice-President](#) after five years in which it was closed and its functions folded into a ministry division. Its Secretary of State puts its near-term focus on technological innovation in government procedures and on accelerating the digitalisation of public-service delivery. No commencement notice for the NISTI Act 2025 is on record, so the body is described as functioning without the statute behind it being shown to be in force.

Sierra Leone

Delivering a ministerial statement on 4 August after [MPs demanded an explanation for the surge](#), the communications minister [set out education, institutional strengthening and better investigation](#). No liability rule, refund duty or operator obligation was proposed.

South Africa

The state put two studies out to tender and conceded the gap they are meant to fill. The communications department's market-analysis tender [concedes a current policy vacuum and that the price benefits expected from the 2022 spectrum auction remain largely unmet](#), naming market concentration, spectrum allocation and the burden

on prepaid consumers as structural causes; its deliverables are a cost-to-communicate roadmap and an assessment of progress on the 2019 data-services market inquiry recommendations. A second tender [seeks an ICT-indicators and scenario-modelling system to steer the digital economy to 2050](#), with no award, value or delivery date. Against both, the reform programme's quarterly report [concedes progress has been uneven and in certain instances slower than initially anticipated](#), against the 80% on-track figure that remains its dated prior.

A third instrument is being fast-tracked rather than tendered. The Presidency and the planning and evaluation department [put a digital dashboard monitoring mega infrastructure projects before the parliamentary committee on the Presidency](#), alongside a wider review of progress against the state-of-the-nation commitments. No delivery date, data source, custodian or statement of whether the dashboard will be public is given — which for a monitoring instrument is the whole of the question. The portfolio minister separately [set out persistent governance and liquidity problems across the department's eleven state-owned entities](#), citing progress stabilising boards and the state IT agency's leadership, a completed public broadcaster funding model now with the Treasury, and ruling out a compulsory household levy.

The Department of Communications and Digital Technologies stated on 29 July that the redrafted national AI policy [will issue guidelines rather than prescribe rules](#), and that the seven institutions proposed in the withdrawn draft are being reconsidered; cabinet consideration is targeted for November 2026, with January 2027 as fallback. On 31 July the chair of Parliament's communications portfolio committee stated her [opposition to creating new AI regulators](#).

Tanzania

At a university health conference on 31 July the government stated [three requirements: that health data be stored inside Tanzania, that healthcare AI systems be approved by the relevant authorities, and that local capacity to build them be developed](#). No instrument and no approving authority was named, and a dedicated regulator was called for from the floor rather than announced.

The coordination that did get a name came from outside the state. A [multi-stakeholder body launched on 8 August to coordinate cybersecurity, data privacy, artificial-intelligence governance and payment security across government, industry and academia](#), founded by a security firm with a privacy professionals' association and a fintech association, and naming the data protection commission, the ICT commission and the private sector federation among its partners; the [same forum published a digital trust outlook report and inaugurated a cross-border corridor with the Gulf Cooperation Council for regulatory dialogue, secure payments and artificial-intelligence governance](#). No constitution, funding, membership list or statement of the named regulators' role in it is held.

Togo

The [government roadmap for 2026-2031 is in force](#) with headline targets of a doubling of gross domestic product per head and poverty below 15 per cent. The text is not held, no digital chapter or digital target is on record, and the three sectoral tracks at its private-sector workshop of 30 July were agro-industry, logistics and transport, and energy — none of them digital. The [regulator's head was elected president of the West African regulators' association](#) at the assembly Togo hosted in April.

Uganda

The ICT ministry [states a device-tax-cut paper is ready for cabinet before the end of the quarter](#). The [proposals behind it would take excise duty on data and airtime from 12% to 5% and VAT on mobile data from 18% to 14%](#), with duty relief on entry-level handsets; no measure is adopted and the study itself is not held.

Zambia

The head of the Presidential Delivery Unit said on 17 July 2026 that Zambia's National AI Strategy was nearing completion and invited stakeholder contributions ([statement](#)). Against that, a continental review published on 1 July reads a Zambian national AI strategy alongside six others as an existing analysable text. Nothing on file settles whether a draft has been circulated to researchers without being published, or whether the review is in error.

Zimbabwe

The ICT ministry committed on 29 July to an artificial-intelligence ethics framework tabled by the end of the first quarter of 2027, publishing neither a standard nor a compliance deadline ([launch account](#)).

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